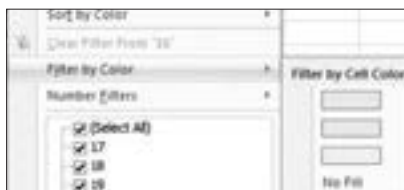


4.2.2 Filtering

When you use filtering, you limit the visibility of a table's contents to only those entries that match the criteria specified in the filter. To perform a Filtering operation on a range of cells, select any cell in that range and click on the Filter button. This will cause the first row of the range to be converted into a header row with each cell containing a drop-down menu that shows the filtering options. The drop-down contains a few inbuilt filters that can discriminate between numbers and colours of the cells.



Filter by Number Options



Filter by Colour Options

The Number Filters link already offers a few filter criteria like Above, Below, Greater Than, etc. Selecting any of these will open up a window to choose the threshold value. This window can also be used to create a Custom Filter, and you can also use wildcard characters like “?” and “*”. You can also create a compound criterion by adding the AND/OR clause and adding another condition. The Above Average and Below Average filters simply calculates the average for the column, and displays only those which fulfil the corresponding condition.

You clear Filters by clicking on the Clear button in the Sort and Filter Block. The Advanced button allows creating more complex filter conditions than those already mentioned. Conditions that can be used under Advanced filtering can include simple mathematical operations, wildcards, and even functions supported by Excel.

Before using Advanced filtering, a little preparation is needed.